

Case Study: UPI Payment Fraud

A college student named Rohan was trying to sell his old headphones on an online marketplace. After posting the ad, he received a message from a person who seemed genuinely interested in buying them. The buyer quickly agreed to the price and said he would send the payment through UPI.

Instead of sending money, the buyer shared a QR code and asked Rohan to scan it to “receive” the payment. Trusting the buyer, Rohan scanned the code and entered his UPI PIN without thinking much. Within seconds, money was deducted from his bank account instead of being credited.

The scammer then stopped responding and disappeared. Rohan realized too late that he had been tricked. In UPI systems, entering your PIN is only required when you are sending money, not receiving it. The scammer took advantage of this lack of awareness.

Such scams usually target students or people who are not fully aware of how digital payments work. They often create urgency or act very convincing to gain trust quickly. The consequences can include financial loss, stress, and loss of confidence in online platforms.

This case highlights the importance of understanding how digital payment systems work and being cautious while dealing with unknown people online.